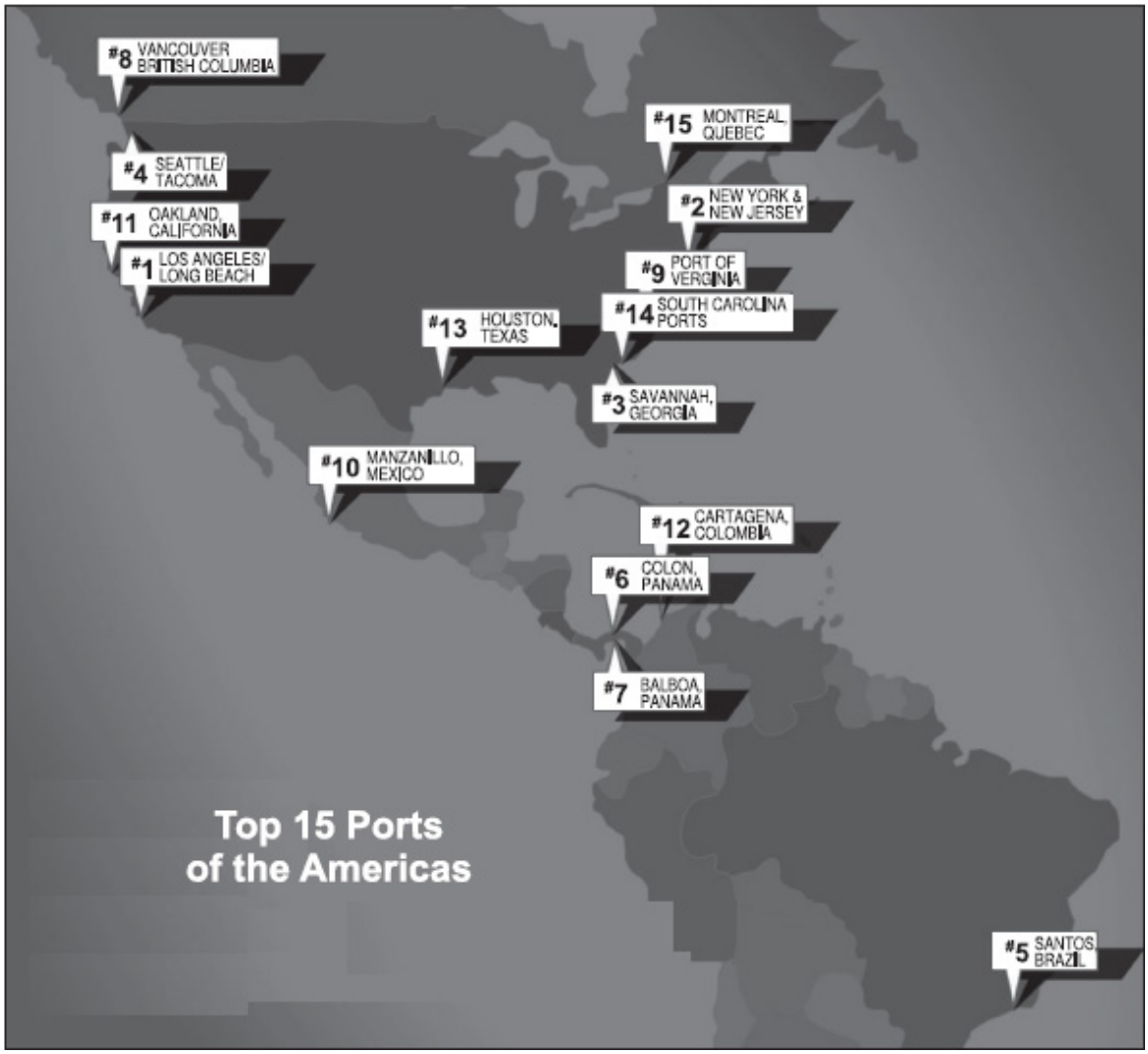
Explanation (49)



52. **Paleozoic orogenic belts:**

Erosional remnants of ancient mountain ranges occur along the eastern, northern, and southern margins of the continent. The mountains were formed mainly between 400 and 300 million years ago, when North America collided with other continents to form the ancient supercontinent of Pangaea. The Ouachita Orogen (mountain chain) formed when the south- facing margin of North America collided with South America, the Appalachian Orogen when the southeast-facing margin collided with northwestern Africa, the Caledonian Orogen when the northeast- facing margin collided with northwestern Europe, and the Franklinian Orogen when the Arctic margin collided with crust that now underlies the